

Obviously, noncancelable and guaranteed renewable is the best type but will also be the most expensive. Avoid conditionally renewable policies. You want to have the assurance that your coverage will be there when you need it.

Buy residual disability benefits. This means if you aren't totally disabled but can't work full-time, you'll be paid partial benefits. Expect to pay between 1 and 3 percent of your annual income for a long-term disability policy, so if you're earning \$30,000, a policy will probably cost you between \$300 and \$900 a year. Your cost will depend on your age and the policy features you choose. The average period of disability is about three years.